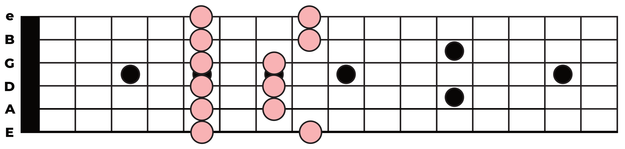
"How To Solo Along To Any Song On Guitar" Official Cheat Sheet

by Andrew Clarke

STEPS TO SOLOING:

Step 1: Identify the key of the song
Step 2: Align your scale with the key of the song
Step 3: Play notes from the scale to create your own melodies

POSITION #1 PENTATONIC SCALE:

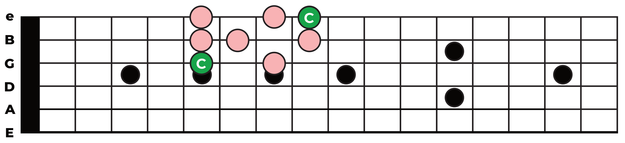


HOW TO FIND THE KEY OF A SONG:

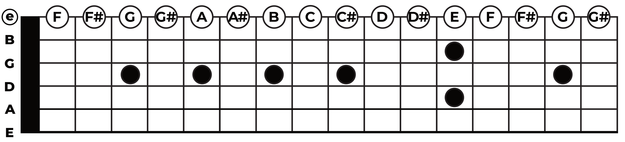
Using the simple major scale shape below, move it up and down the fretboard until you find a location where every note sounds like it "fits" the song you're listening to.

Once you're confident you have the scale in the correct position, find the name of the last note of the scale on the high E string. That note will give you the name of your MAJOR key.

MAJOR SCALE SHAPE:

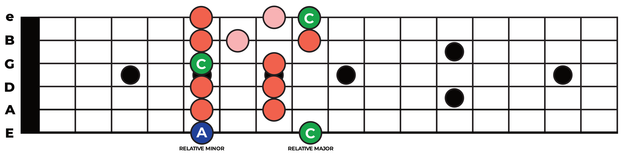


NOTES ON THE HIGH E STRING:



WHERE THE PENTATONIC FITS IN:

Position #1 of the PENTATONIC scale lives right on top of the MAJOR scale shape you used to find the key. So that puts your PENTATONIC scale in the correct position to start using it to solo with.



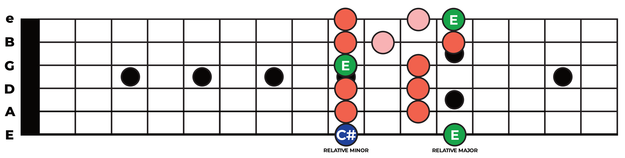
RELATIVE MAJOR & MINOR SCALES:

This one scale shape covers both MAJOR and MINOR keys because of something called "RELATIVE SCALES." So if you decide to look up the key of a song instead of finding it yourself, you can use the following method to position your scale correctly.

Align your FIRST finger on the low E string with the note name of the MINOR key or your FOURTH finger on the low E string with the note name of the MAJOR key.

PLAYING IN OTHER KEYS:

It's as simple as shifting everything up or down the fretboard into the correct position. No other changes need to be made. Here's an example of the same shape in E MAJOR/C# MINOR.



TURNING SCALES INTO MELODIES:

By changing the order of the notes in the scale, changing the rhythm, and adding different lead guitar techniques like vibrato, bends, or slides, you'll start coming up with your own melodies.

Rather than copying set licks or solos from someone else, try noodling around and developing your own ideas. This is one of the best ways to start creating a sound that is unique to you! Happy playing!

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